

Internship Overview

During my internship with ***Elysia Gems & Jewels***, I worked as an Independent Sales Broker. I contributed approximately 200 hours throughout the internship. My primary duties included unearthing and acquiring new clients, especially jewelry shops, resellers, and wholesalers; managing ongoing client relationships; promoting jewelry pieces using the company catalog; taking and submitting detailed orders, including custom specifications; and ensuring payment was collected in two phases—50% in advance and the remainder 50% before delivery. I operated as an independent contractor, earning a commission on completed and fully paid sales.

New Things I Learned

This internship provided me with empirical experience in autonomous client acquisition, B2B sales, and rapport management. I learned how to adapt pitches based on diverse client profiles, gained insight into the importance of prepayment collection to mitigate business risks, and enhanced my understanding of custom product sales. I also became familiar with how various marketing tools and product catalogs can be integrated and leveraged to support client interactions efficiently.

Things That Surprised Me

What surprised me most was the level of autonomy I was given and how much responsibility I had in managing the entire sales process, from prospecting to payment collection. I didn't expect to be so directly accountable for ensuring clients made timely payments, especially as a non-employee. Additionally, I was impressed by the emphasis on

reputation and branding and how much it impacted client trust and buying behavior in the jewelry industry.

What I Learned To Do Well Due To My Experience

I learned the importance of always doing my best under various circumstances to carry out tasks efficiently, especially in any retail sector, because customer satisfaction with well-served product quality and services is always the number one priority to ensure long-term profitability and customer loyalty. During this process, I also learned how to utilize my interpersonal skills to negotiate with different kinds of clients under different circumstances to carry out things efficiently - communication is the key for establishing rapport with clients. Overall, this experience greatly enhanced my interpersonal skills as well as my marketing flair to transform me into a more well-rounded person.

EMPAC Model Relations

In my internship role, I had a chance to truly see how the EMPAC model—**Entertainment, Matching, Price, Assortment, and Convenience**—applies, even within a niche, small, but custom-focused jewelry business. This experience significantly enriched my understanding of consumer behavior and shaped how I approached my duties as an independent broker.

Entertainment: Although my role was remote, I quickly discovered that Elysia isn't just about selling jewelry; they're about creating meaningful experiences. Every gemstone has a story—their origins, the craftsmanship behind them, and the emotional connections they fostered add significant depth to each sale. Incorporating emotional storytelling into my pitches made my sales conversations far more engaging and meaningful.

Matching: One of Elysia's greatest strengths is personalization. Whether it was custom birthstones or tailor-made wedding sets, each client received jewelry that resonated not just aesthetically but also emotionally. Understanding and translating nuanced client preferences into precise product recommendations became a vital part of my role. Even working remotely, I embraced the empathy and precision that Elysia's gemologists brought to each client interaction.

Price: Given Elysia's position in the niche premium market, effectively communicating the value behind higher prices was crucial. I learned to articulate price not merely as an expense but as a reflection of the meticulous craftsmanship, ethical sourcing, and the unique character of each piece. Clients often recognized the value and were willing to invest more once they understood these deeper aspects.

Assortment: Apart from large-scale jewelry retailers, Elysia offers depth rather than solely breadth. Their strength lies in the ability to create customized pieces and adapt existing catalog items, ensuring each creation feels unique and personal. Recognizing this allowed me to confidently reassure clients who valued exclusivity and originality over mass-produced alternatives.

Convenience: Despite being a tiny brand, Elysia effectively leveraged digital resources, making their products accessible to clients worldwide. I learned how valuable digital tools could be—from sharing catalog PDFs and using various social media platforms like LinkTree and LinkedIn for personalized follow-ups, to hosting virtual consultations. These approaches reinforced that true convenience is about providing clarity, building trust, and delivering a seamless experience, regardless of physical distance.

Overall, applying the EMPAC model helped me become more client-focused, thoughtful in my communications, and strategic in

emphasizing Elysia's unique competitive advantages during every client interaction.